

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY

 **ATTACK REPORT**

Turla APT used ANDROMEDA malware to infiltrate a variety of industries

Date of Publication

January 9, 2023

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2023013

Summary

First appeared: 1996

Threat Actor: Turla

Attack Region: Afghanistan, Algeria, Armenia, Australia, Austria, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Belgium, Bolivia, Botswana, Brazil, China, Chile, Denmark, Ecuador, Estonia, Finland, France, Georgia, Germany, Hong Kong, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Iran, Iraq, Italy, Jamaica, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Kuwait, Latvia, Mexico, Netherlands, Pakistan, Paraguay, Poland, Qatar, Romania, Russia, Serbia, Spain, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, Sweden, Switzerland, Syria, Tajikistan, Thailand, Tunisia, Turkmenistan, UK, Ukraine, Uruguay, USA, Uzbekistan, Venezuela, Vietnam, Yemen.

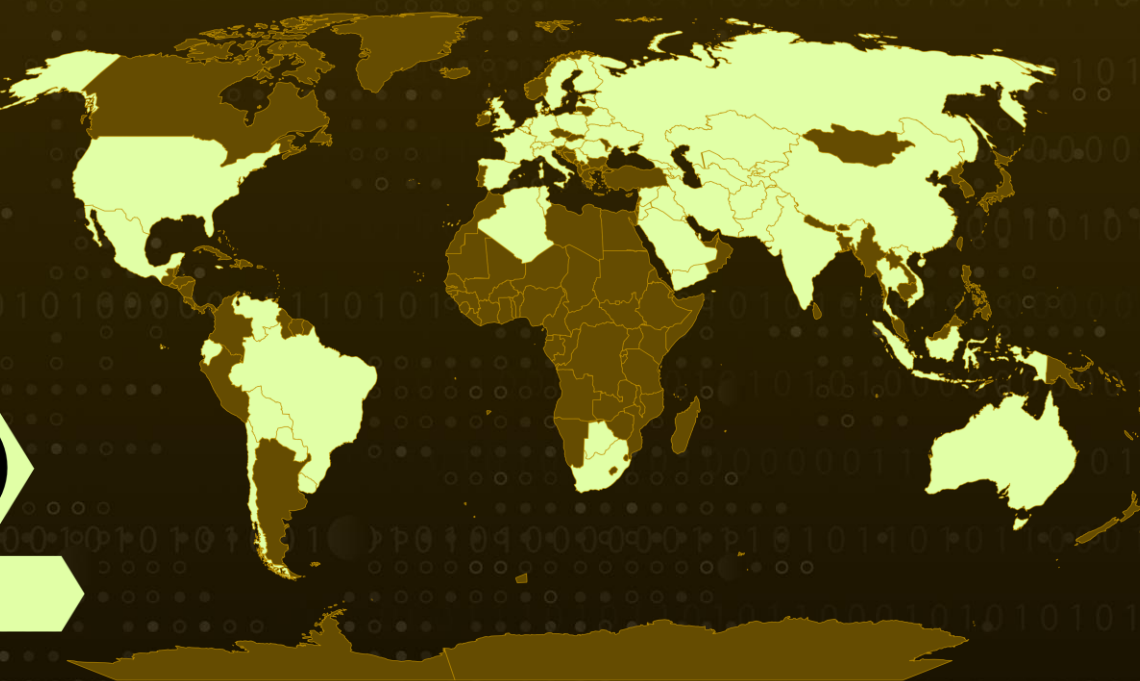
Attack Industries: Aerospace, Defense, Education, Embassies, Energy, Government, High-Tech, IT, Media, NGOs, Pharmaceutical, Research, Retail.

Attack: The Turla Group is reportedly distributing the KOPILUWAK reconnaissance software and the QUIETCANARY backdoor to victims of ANDROMEDA malware in Ukraine.

✂ Attack Regions



Turla



Powered by Bing
© Australia Bureau of Statistics, GeoNames, Microsoft, Navinfo, OpenStreetMap, TomTom

Attack Details

#1

In September 2022, the Turla Team operation began profiling victims in order to selectively deploy KOPILUWAK and QUIETCANARY. ANDROMEDA malware, which was prevalent in the early 2010s and spread through infected USB drives, was used to infect devices. When the ANDROMEDA software was run on a device, it remained present by installing another version of itself on the device.

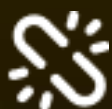
#2

KOPILUWAK is a JavaScript-based reconnaissance utility that has been distributed to victims as a first-stage malicious email attachment. It is used to assist C2 interactions and victim profiling. Following the initial execution and reconnaissance carried out using KOPILUWAK, a lightweight .NET backdoor called QUIETCANARY was downloaded, which was primarily used to collect and exfiltrate data from the victim.

#3

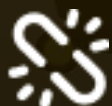
The campaign's operational approaches appear to be compatible with Turla's planning considerations and adapt their follow-up exploitation attempts to capture and exfiltrate strategic information. This unique method of claiming expired domains, which is employed by widely distributed, financially motivated malware, can allow for subsequent intrusions at a wide range of enterprises.

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0007</u> Discovery
<u>TA0009</u> Collection	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>TA0040</u> Impact	<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information
<u>T1055</u> Process Injection	<u>T1070</u> Indicator Removal	<u>T1070.004</u> File Deletion	<u>T1112</u> Modify Registry
<u>T1564</u> Hide Artifacts	<u>T1564.003</u> Hidden Window	<u>T1622</u> Debugger Evasion	<u>T1547</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution
<u>T1547.001</u> Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	<u>T1010</u> Application Window Discovery	<u>T1012</u> Query Registry	<u>T1033</u> System Owner/User Discovery
<u>T1049</u> System Network Connections Discovery	<u>T1057</u> Process Discovery	<u>T1082</u> System Information Discovery	<u>T1083</u> File and Directory Discovery
<u>T1518</u> Software Discovery	<u>T1560</u> Archive Collected Data	<u>T1560.001</u> Archive via Utility	<u>T1584</u> Compromise Infrastructure
<u>T1608</u> Stage Capabilities	<u>T1608.003</u> Install Digital Certificate	<u>T1071</u> Application Layer Protocol	<u>T1071.001</u> Web Protocols
<u>T1573</u> Encrypted Channel	<u>T1573.002</u> Asymmetric Cryptography	<u>T1529</u> System Shutdown/Reboot	

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
MD5	bc76bd7b332aa8f6aedbb8e11b7ba9b6 b3657bcfe8240bc0985093a0f8682703 2eb6df8795f513c324746646b594c019 d8233448a3400c5677708a8500e3b2a0 403876977dfb4ab2e2c15ad4b29423ff 8954caa2017950e0f6269d6f6168b796

TYPE	VALUE
Domains	suckmycocklameavindustry[.]in yelp[.]cloudns[.]cl anam0rph[.]su manager.surro[.]am
IP Addresses	212.114.52[.]24 194.67.209[.]186

References

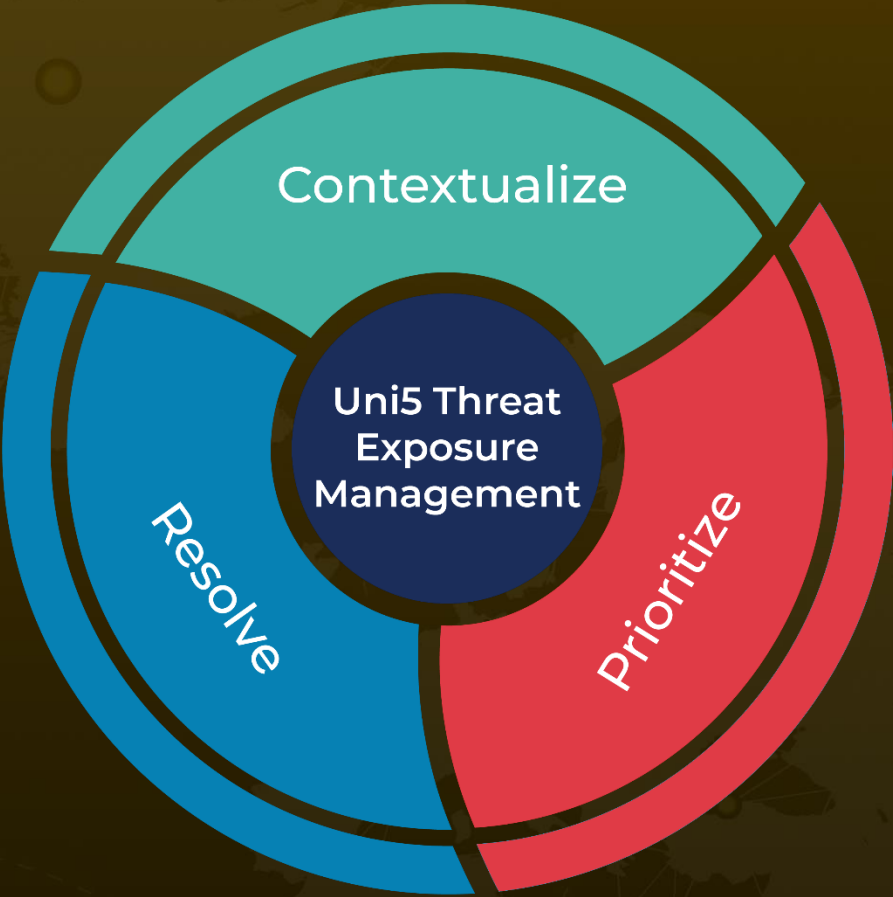
<https://www.mandiant.com/resources/blog/turla-galaxy-opportunity>

<https://attack.mitre.org/groups/G0010/>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



REPORT GENERATED ON
January 9, 2023 • 4:25 AM

© 2023 All Rights are Reserved by HivePro



More at www.hivepro.com